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COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Head of Context Engineering at Workfabric AI Sees Sierra AI as Advanced but Calls for Greater Transparency and Continuous Learning

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
16 Jun 2026	18 Mar 2026	Customer	Business-Led	SIERRA.AI

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The conversation focused on the technical evaluation, implementation, and performance of Sierra AI as an AI agent vendor for enterprise customer support. Key topics included automation rates, pricing transparency, integration challenges, ROI, and areas for improvement in vendor transparency and continuous learning.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Head of Context Engineering at an AI platform company, responsible for technical evaluation, security, compliance, and implementation of AI vendor solutions, including leading the AI Review Board and overseeing integration and deployment for enterprise use cases.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- **The expert views Sierra AI as a state-of-the-art solution with strong automation and performance, but notes significant room for improvement in transparency and continuous learning processes**.
- They believe **Sierra AI's unique outcome-based pricing model is attractive but creates challenges in understanding true value and resolution definitions, leading to some skepticism**.
- The expert expects greater ROI and efficiency as deployment scales, but emphasizes the need for more transparency and feedback mechanisms to increase confidence and adoption.

TAKEAWAYS

- Automation performance, security/compliance, and integration capabilities are critical factors in vendor selection, with Sierra AI performing well in automation and compliance but only moderately in integration and customization.
- **Sierra AI's outcome-based pricing is unique and attractive, but the lack of transparency in what constitutes a 'resolved' case and limited traceability are major concerns**.
- **The expert achieved approximately 60% automation with Sierra AI, slightly below the initial expectation of 70%, resulting in ROI of just over 2x, though this was below** target due to pilot-scale deployment.
- Continuous improvement and feedback loops for model updates are not well-defined, making **it difficult to ensure ongoing enhancements and alignment with client needs**.
- **End-user adoption and change management require significant effort, with skepticism among human agents** and a need for clear communication about the AI's role and limitations.

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Expert Bio

Head of Context Engineering at Workfabric AI (customer of Sierra). Workfabric AI is building the context engine for enterprise AI. Head of Context Engineering at Workfabric AI. Workfabric AI is building the context engine for enterprise AI. Former Vice President of Machine Learning at UnitedHealth Group, leaving December 2025. Reporting to the CEO, the expert is responsible for providing product outlook, driving strategy, and successfully executing across numerous clouds. Prior to UnitedHealth Group Incorporated, the expert was the Director

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of Imaging AI at Tempus Labs, Inc, leaving in October 2022. The expert was responsible for leading Machine Learning for radiology and toxicology screening data. The expert was also responsible for analyzing data used for Machine Learning. The expert was responsible for driving the company's Radiology and Cell Imaging efforts for data-driven precision medicine as well as building the company's Artificial Intelligence and Data Science organization and driving the vision for multimodal data-driven outcome predictions, the discovery of novel biomarkers, and using data to improve all parts of the company. The expert was using MetaXpress for image acquisition and analysis. The expert can speak to and has implemented advanced AI and machine learning techniques, computer vision, surgical analytics, and precision medicine technologies.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Thanks for taking the time to speak about the company Sierra AI. Before we start, can you walk me through your exposure to Sierra AI, and what role did you play personally when it came to the evaluation and the buying decision?

Expert 00:00:15

Absolutely. I'll introduce myself first. I have two roles. One is as the AI platform engineering Lead. We are building a platform called United AI Studio that sits on top of the cloud service providers like the hyperscalers, again, mostly with a security governance and compliance view. As part of that, we are actually building out something called an AI Review Board. Any vendor that comes on board, including Sierra AI, has to clear all of the security compliance requirements and also go through the AI Review Board to essentially become a vendor that can be used across the enterprise.

I own the engineering platform and the execution of the AI Review Board itself. As part of that, I'm the technical evaluator for these vendor platforms. I also have an additional responsibility of building out specific solutions for various lines of businesses. As part of that, I've engaged with some of our businesses that want to use AI for customer support. I'm also assisting them with technical evaluation metrics and vendor approval.

Client 00:01:28

Perfect. If I understand correctly, you're more involved in the technical aspect of it, the implementation of it, ensuring that it aligns with different security and data governance aspects. Were you also involved in the buying decision when you came to evaluate different AI agent vendors in the market? Considering factors such as pricing, such as ease of use, or when talking with vendors, doing the conversation with their sales reps, asking questions, trying to understand more, were you involved in that process as well?

Expert 00:01:59

Any vendor approval process is kind of like a joint decision between various stakeholders. Like you said there is the procurement and contracting team that is involved as well. I think they ask a lot of the vendor SOC two approvals, and supply chain, and then there is the security compliance team that does the architecture review and compliance. There is the actual AI model performance, that is where we come in. There, we look at, again, not just model performance, but any sort of SLAs around that model performance in terms of cost or latency or availability, and all of that. Eventually, when we make a final decision, it's kind of sort of an aggregation of all of these factors and the various stakeholder decisions to make the final call.

Client 00:02:47

Perfect. That's great. Let's move forward. What I'm going to do is I want to give you a list of factors, and we call these buying factors, and then I'd like you to rate each factor from one to five, one being not very important when it came to evaluating vendors, AI agents, providers, and five is very important for your buying decision. I just want to understand the weight that these buying factors have when evaluating vendors, and then for each one of those factors, I would also like you to rate them in terms of Sierra AI's performance.

Let's start with the first one. The first one is around the product, and it's around automation performance, the percentage **that the AI agent completes successfully** end-to-end without human intervention. How important was that from one to five when it comes to evaluating vendors in the market?

Expert 00:03:38

Five.

Client 00:03:39

Can you talk a little bit about why?

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Expert 00:03:42

Yeah, that's five for us. That's critical. I think because the fundamental use case itself is kind of centered around automation and seeing how we can essentially realize, not just efficiency and cost reduction and all of that, but fundamentally improve the end user experience. Today, if you look at something like customer support, there's very long wait times, and often people not able to get through to a human agent because wait times are too long, and so on. Fundamentally, user experience is kind of dependent on this as well. I think for a number of different reasons, the whole point of sort of modernizing customer support is to make sure that you can at least guarantee some level of automation. That is something that we take very seriously.

Client 00:04:28

Perfect. Thank you. In terms of Sierra AI's performance with respect to that factor, how would you rate their performance from one to five?

Expert 00:04:38

I would say Sierra is maybe a four, four and a half, something like that. I mean, not a perfect five, but pretty good.

Client 00:04:47

Perfect. Let's go to the other factor. This is around AI agent quality and accuracy. In other words, how accurate are the AI agents' outputs and decisions as you compare it to human performance? How would you rate that factor from one to five in terms of the weight that it had on evaluating vendors?

Expert 00:05:08

I would give it a four. Just as an explanation, what I mean is, it is okay for the AI agent to say, "I don't know," and be conservative and sort of escalate to a human, but it is not okay for **the AI agent actually give out wrong answers**. When I say it's a four, I basically mean that the majority of the times the answer should be correct, but there could be times where the agent is just unsure what the answer is, or it's time to play it safe, and then it's just sending it out to a human instead of somehow giving the wrong answer.

Client 00:05:43

That's great. How would you rate Sierra in terms of the accuracy of their AI agents?

Expert 00:05:49

I would give Sierra also maybe a four in that. There is a little bit of a black box nature to the way Sierra operates. Maybe we'll talk about it at some point because they do outcome-based pricing, and we don't fully have 100% visibility into how exactly the calls are getting routed and what calls are getting resolved. I would say that gives them a little bit of a black box nature, which prevents a perfect five.

Client 00:06:16

Perfect. We're definitely going to talk about that when it comes to pricing. That was very helpful. Thank you. Let's go to the other factor. We're still talking about product. In this case, the factor is around features, so configuration capabilities, integrations, the level of customization of the AI agent, and all that. Was that important in terms of your evaluating of vendors? From one to five, how would you rate that?

Expert 00:06:47

That's a five for us. It's very important to integrate into legacy systems and to existing workflows and things like that. That's a very important fact.

Client 00:06:59

How did Sierra perform from one of five?

Expert 00:07:02

I would say it's three. It was not without its pains of integration, and even from a support responsiveness standpoint and all that, I think it's probably a three.

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Client 00:07:12

Great. Let's go to the other factor. **This is about ease of use and deployment** and the time to value. How quickly can you go from purchase to having a functioning AI agent delivering real business value? In **terms of ease of deployment and time** to value, how important was that when considering vendors?

Expert 00:07:32

It's pretty important. I would say it's a four. Again, there is obviously a little bit of leeway around exactly how we define time to value in the sense that there is not a hard deadline saying, "Okay, I want by week number 12, I want ROI," or something like that, so people are willing to be a little bit more patient and give it time to ramp up and things like that. It is eventually time box. We want to essentially show ROI within X weeks or X months of installation. It is a four, I would say.

Client 00:08:08

Okay, great. How would you rate Sierra for that?

Expert 00:08:12

Sierra is four when it comes to that. Once the integration was complete, essentially we were able to get it going. We did have a little bit of back and forth in terms of the whole customization, and how do we make sure that all the policies are in there and fully compliant with how we want it answered and things like that. Outside of that, I would say time to value is pretty reasonable.

Client 00:08:37

Great, thank you. Next factor is trust, security, compliance, and data privacy standards. How important was that when evaluating vendors?

Expert 00:08:49

Yeah, this is critical. It's a five for us. Any vendor can even come to our AI Review Board only if they already have cleared all of these privacy requirements and compliance requirements. Where the model is hosted, how was the model trained? Does the data ever leave the system? Are you guys training your models on our data? All of these are crucial questions that we have to get answered before anything happens. I would give it a five. I think they met all the requirements.

Client 00:09:24

Great. Next factor, we're going to talk about pricing. In terms of pricing, in terms of simplicity, transparency, and predictability, how important was this? I know that you talk a little bit about this, so if you can expand on this, that would be great, but first, how would you rate this in terms of importance when considering vendors?

Expert 00:09:46

I would give it a four in terms of importance for us. Obviously, pricing will have direct impact on the budget and what is allocated and all that, but again, at the end of the day, teams want to see the solution actually deployed, and they have a mandate to go execute. Especially something like a Sierra AI, we don't necessarily have an in-house competing product, so it's not as if we have a low-cost solution available. There will be some negotiation with the vendor, but then price is not a critical factor. Even if it's 10%-20% more than expected, we would typically just go with it in terms of.

transparency is important. Transparency is crucial for us to be able to understand what are the different factors that go into the final bill, and in the future, if we wanted to reduce spend, what do we need to do, and things like that. I would give Sierra AI a three when it comes to pricing, again, because primarily because we feel that transparency is lacking. It's outcome-based pricing, which is great, which is essentially they get paid for only what they are able to automate, but then what is it that **they are automating is a little bit of a black box problem,** and the transparency is not quite there.

Client 00:11:03

That's interesting, and very helpful to know. Thank you. Talking about pricing, what about how cheap was the vendor compared to other vendors? In other words, the total cost of ownership. I know that you talked a little bit about this in your previous answer, but the total cost of ownership, including implementation, ongoing use, how important was it that **the vendor was lower than competing solutions**?

Expert 00:11:29

I would say it's a little bit of a trade off between overall performance and vendor cost. I mean, total cost of ownership, if you will. I think all things being equal, in terms of performance or compatible, then I think the deciding factor would be the TCO, but I don't think that was quite

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the case with this vendor. I would say, in this case, the total cost of ownership was probably a three in terms of overall importance because **it got outweighed by model performance** and whether we had equivalent models out there.

Client 00:12:00

In terms of Sierra, would you say that they have average pricing, or **they were more expensive than the others,** or cheaper? How would you rate that from one to five?

Expert 00:12:11

Definitely, I think I would give them a four maybe. I would say more expensive than the others, but then also **I think definitely industry leading in terms of the performance of the solution** itself.

Client 00:12:23

Perfect. Let's move along. Let's talk about the selling approach. The ability for the vendor to demonstrate applicability to your specific workflows, to demonstrate value in the pre-sales process, proof, deep demos, case studies, and all of that, how important was that when evaluating vendors?

Expert 00:12:44

Those are crucial. I would say those are a five. As part of the RFP process, and even in the response that the vendor gives us, usually there is a lot of references to case studies. The more relatable the case studies are, if they are in the same domain as the domain in which we are, I think it makes it even more relatable and realistic. From all that perspective, I think it's very important for us to overall understand benchmarks, what model are they trained on, how customizable the policies are that if we have certain reimbursement rates and certain network coverage and things like that, we want the model to accurately reflect all of that and be grounded in that data. All of that is crucial for us. It's definitely five.

Sierra AI, I would say, came out with a five as well, out of the box. I think where we are probably lacking a little bit is in the sense that what kind of continuous improvement we can expect from the model, in the sense that if it essentially made mistakes during calls with the customers or gave out wrong policy information and things like that, how do we essentially take that feedback and then translate that model performance improvements in the next iteration? That is a little bit lacking both in terms of transparency and turnaround time, but otherwise, I think they did great.

Client 00:14:09

You will give them a five?

Expert 00:14:11

I would give them a four.

Client 00:14:15

Four. Yeah, that's very interesting. They provided the case studies, they provided the demos, they demonstrate how it can work with your domain and your specific use case workflows, and all of that, but what you're saying is that there was an opportunity area to demonstrate how the model can improve further based on mistakes and ongoing use.

Expert 00:14:36

That's correct. Yes.

Client 00:14:39

Perfect. Very helpful. Thank you. The other factors are around the operating model. What I mean by this is, for instance, the self-service tools for adoption. They provide those self-service tools so that you can implement, configure, manage the AI agents independently with minimal vendor support if you need it. How important was that for evaluating vendors?

Expert 00:15:06

I would say that is probably a three. I think, in fact we would probably prefer that it's permanent hands-on support available from them, and then they take care of all the model tuning and so on, because otherwise they would have to have a dedicated tech team on the ground that is permanently attached to this solution and then having to deal with operations and management of it.

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Right now, it's very lightweight on our side. It's a pretty outsourced solution. I would say so. That's probably a three for us, and Sierra AI also in terms of how they perform, it's not very customizable from our end. I would give them even a two there. I think it's very heavily reliant on us reaching out to them and requesting them to make these changes rather than them just giving us a whole bunch of controls and us figuring it out.

Client 00:15:56

Perfect. The other factor, I think you already talked about this, it's about that consultative approach. How hands-on were they in terms of implementation? Do they provide a dedicated implementation support, ongoing strategic guidance throughout the journey? How would you rate that in terms of importance?

Expert 00:16:16

I would say for us that was a five in terms of importance because at the end of the day, integration is crucial, and to be able to do integration testing and user acceptance testing and all of that is crucial. We need the vendors engaged all the way, so that for user adoption, they need to be able to trust the system and understand the system, how to use it, and on. I would say **Sierra AI was pretty good at that**. I would give them also a five.

Client 00:16:48

Great. Last two factors. One is about the path to value. How clear are the set of metrics and processes set up to measure the success of implementation and the value capture of the product? If the provider gave you that path and you were very clear about the milestones and the things that you need to do and to understand the different levels of ROI across the journey that you're going to be able to realize, how important was that when evaluating vendors?

Expert 00:17:16

The path to value is very, very important. For us, I would say that's a five, because at the end of the day, everything is rooted in ROI. Any further expansions and the further budgeting that happens for this effort is contingent on what kind of ROI we got from the initial deployment. From that standpoint, definitely a five for us. I would say **Sierra AI probably performed at about a high three**, maybe 3.7, 3.8, coming up on four, maybe. I think **they were a little bit below expectation** when it came to the percentage of calls that were automated, but then we attributed it to something that would improve over time, which is what we are working with them on. Other than that, I think out of the box, they did provide a reasonable amount of automation.

Client 00:18:06

Great. Last factor is integration support. How supported you felt when you were dealing with complex system integrations. How important was that for evaluating providers?

Expert 00:18:18

I would say maybe a four. Integration itself is crucial. We do have tech teams on the ground that work on integration, so we rely on some support. I wouldn't say that's a major deciding factor in terms of overall vendor approval. Sierra AI was probably, I would say, also a four when it came to that.

Client 00:18:42

Perfect. That's awesome. Thank you. Let's talk a little bit about the selling process from the vendors and from Sierra AI specifically. I just like to know, how do you evaluate their selling approach? In other words, do you think that their selling approach was very structured? What I mean by that is, were you just talking or your team was just talking with a sales rep, or did they brought the specific AI technical specialist to answer specific questions? Can you talk a little bit about that? How would you evaluate that from Sierra AI?

Expert 00:19:19

I think they did bring their A team for sure when they initially submitted the proposal and showed us the pitch deck and the demos, we also did a small proof of concept, and we had some historical data, recorded voice data on which we wanted to understand how their model would perform and things like that. They did pretty well on that overall. I would say **they were quite responsive and did a good job** there.

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Client 00:19:46

Perfect. What about the commercial terms, the pricing structure that they offer? Was this usage- or resolution-based pricing, outcome-aligned, or was this more traditional licenses seat based and all that? Can you talk a little bit about that?

Expert 00:20:02

It was definitely outcome-based pricing. They would only get paid for calls that would automatically get resolved through their AI agent, and anything that would end up escalating to a human, they would not get paid for. That's where it was a good model for us because then we were only paying for the value that we would eventually get from that agent.

In that sense, it was really good, but to fully understand whether what they are defining as a result is truly the end state because a lot of times these calls never even come to the human, so we have to essentially listen back to the recordings or we have to do customer surveys and actually ask the customer like, "Hey, was your issue actually resolved? How satisfied are you?" Things like that, or do some random audits.

It was kind of some reverse engineering that we had to do on our end to figure out what is **the definition of resolved and whether there was any sort of false positives and things like that**. Outside of that, the model itself is attractive, but how do you add a layer of transparency to it is not super obvious.

Client 00:21:07

Did they help you with that in terms of getting to more transparency in terms of all of the costs, or were you left alone?

Expert 00:21:15

Not really. It was up to us to figure out how exactly we wanted to assert that, but yeah, they would provide us some statistics in terms of what was done to resolve the case and things like that. Whether that was up to standards and whether we would have done it like that ourselves with a human and all that, I think it was up to us to go and determine that.

Client 00:21:37

Do you think that **that is one of the biggest areas of opportunities for Sierra,** and probably other vendors as well, but specifically for them? Do you think that's where most of the improvement can come from, in other words, for you to feel more confident with these type of solutions?

Expert 00:21:53

I think so, yeah. Also, I think it's a little bit of a unique pricing model because every other sort of voice AI agent that we deal with in healthcare, whether it's Hippocratic AI or Ellipsis Health, I don't think any of them is outcome-based. They're all sort of license-based or volume-based, usage-based, per hour charging, and things like that. In some sense, they are unique. That makes them a little bit attractive, like I said, because you can directly equate that to overall success, but I think it would take a little bit of sort of iteration to for everyone to be comfortable it.

Client 00:22:29

That's pretty interesting to know from your side. Thank you. Perfect. Let's move along. Let's talk about implementation a little bit. Where do **you think the real friction** came from when it came to implementation? Was that in the agent training? Was that in terms of change management in the company, from internal aspects? Where do **you think the real friction** came from?

Expert 00:22:56

I would say, there are probably a few different touch points when it comes to integration. One is just the whole engineering aspect of integrating the Sierra AI system into the customer support workflow, and to be able to route it back to humans or the existing workflow when the Sierra AI agent wants to escalate it. I think that is definitely some engineering work to be done there. At a model customization level, grounding the model on our policies, our coverage plans, things like that, I think that also takes some effort. At the same time, we also have to do some benchmarking to understand how does it do today, and whether we need to be tweaking any problems and things like that to make it more compliant with our policies.

There is also the big step of end-user adoption, where essentially you have to do training, because at the end of the day, the human agents are the ones that are going to coexist with this, so to be able to understand where Sierra left off and where they would have to pick up, and just understanding that whole workflow and learning to trust the agent is something crucial. Change management and end-user adoption is another big piece of it.

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Client 00:24:05
That's very interesting. When you talk about end-user adoption, do you think there was something that Sierra could have done, or do, to accelerate that user adoption, or do you think that that falls entirely with the client on how to get to that higher level of adoption?

Expert 00:24:20
Whether it's Sierra or not, **I think with all agentic systems, there is a good deal of skepticism from the human agents** that the agents are taking away their job and things like that. You kind of deal with that in parallel when it comes to adoption. It's about at least messaging to them in the beginning that this is not about headcount reduction. This is more about improving customer experience and reducing backlog and so on, and learning to trust the system, understanding where the boundaries are for the AI agent and where it would come to the human.

There is some training that we put together, and obviously we engaged with Sierra as well. They would come and sort of talk about how the system operates, and what all it can do and what it cannot do, more importantly, so the users can ask questions and then figure out how exactly to engage with that system.

Client 00:25:13
Very interesting. Do you think that Sierra was transparent in that aspect? The other question that I had is, how realistic do you think the time to value was versus what the vendor promised? Do you think that they have very high expectations because **they were exaggerating that time to value,** or do you think that they were being very realistic, and so you didn't have any surprise when it comes to that journey for you for realizing value?

Expert 00:25:40
I mean, there was probably some exaggeration when it came to the original negotiation time and how much value they can bring and things like that, but then eventually when you hit the model with real data and then you look back, you would see that is probably, they fall short of the lofty goals that they set. Outside of that, I don't think there was anything too unexpected that happened. It wasn't perform 20% below expectations or something like that. It was reasonable, but **it was definitely falling** short of the lofty goals.

Client 00:26:11
Great. Let's talk a little bit about the automation rates that you actually achieve versus what was promised. Again, talking a little bit about that time to value, can you talk a little bit about what were the automation rates that you achieved, and where do you think that the gaps in terms of those rates show up?

Expert 00:26:30
The way we set expectations for automation rates is, even when we scope the project, essentially we did sort of a distribution of call times and call complexities and things like that with purely the human in the loop, and were able to come up with, "Okay, what percentage of calls would we classify as low to medium complexity in terms of both effort required and the amount of subject matter expertise that is needed to essentially complete resolve the issue, and then which ones would be high medium to high in complexity, basically.

We expected Sierra would pretty much handle all of the low complexity ones. I mean, our distribution, low complexity came out to probably around the 70% mark, so low to maybe low medium was about 70%. Everything to the right was basically the long tail of things that were getting increasingly complex. That's where we started, but then eventually at runtime, we saw that **Sierra was able to automate probably** somewhere around the 60% mark, and that's why it was still getting there, but that's kind of where we were.

Client 00:27:38
Great. Thank you. That was very helpful. Let's talk a little bit about ROI. Looking back, do you think that this investment deliver on its business case? Did you achieve the ROI that you expected since the beginning? Did you fall short? Was it not very clear for you in terms of knowing that you achieved it or not? Can **you talk a little bit about that aspect, the ROI and the return over the work**, the promise that they made, what you actually achieved, and all of that?

Expert 00:28:11
In terms of ROI, it was, like I said, just tying it back to the answer to the previous question as well, **I think a lot of our cost reduction efforts,** and also the way backlog reduction for phone calls and wait time reduction, things like that, were calculated based on being able to automate away all of these low to low medium complexity cases. **We did fall short on the target ROI**, if you will, a little bit. STill, **I would say, purely from an absolute ROI standpoint**, we did get back at least 2x of what was put in, I would say, or a little over 2x probably in terms of the investment budget. Again, this deployment was not done at full scale. It was a pilot rollout across certain geographies and certain segments of the business.

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When that kind of full scale deployment happens, a lot of the initial cost that we basically had to foot was more overhead costs, in terms of the integration and some of the other things, so when we expand, it won't necessarily just be the same cost over and over again. A lot of it is already done. It would mostly be incremental at that point. I think the ROI would be much greater when the deployment scales up.

Client 00:29:28

In terms of the ROI, in terms of the cost that you mentioned, that's the overhead cost is going to be bigger if you decide to expand the usage and all that, was this a surprise for you when implementing, when using the solution, or was it always understood since the beginning, since you had the first conversations with Sierra?

Expert 00:29:48

I wouldn't say it was fully a surprise. I think we kind of knew what was coming, and we had budgeted for it. All I was trying to say was for the first round, we had factored in something when we are expecting a certain ROI. I mean, **the ROI is falling short of expectations** there, but then, hopefully, this is not a recurring cost. That's what we are counting on for the future scaling.

Client 00:30:15

Perfect. Thank you. I have only three more questions for you. The next question is, is there anything about how Sierra AI operates as a vendor or product that you think analysts in the market tend to underappreciate or get wrong?

Expert 00:30:31

I think it's pretty hyped up, actually. I don't think that they underappreciate it. I would say a good chunk of it is true. I mean, Sierra is kind of the state of the art tech when it comes to all of the different agent integrations that are possible, and then adding the voice layer on top to eventually make it a very domain-specific customer support solution. Yeah, I would say definitely a little bit of the AI hype is baked in, but largely I would say the analysts are on the mark.

Client 00:31:02

Along those lines, what do you think **they overestimate or tend to get wrong** when it comes to giving it too much credit when the reality could be different?

Expert 00:31:11

I think they overestimate the volume of the calls, the penetration that they have in the market, and just how long it takes to get into enterprise and be used at scale. That's not something that's fast. Especially, something like healthcare, some of that is overestimated, I think.

Client 00:31:29

Okay, interesting. Two final questions. What would you say overall, it's something that if **Sierra AI improves, it will help them increase their market share in the market**, their presence, their client satisfaction, client adoption? If you can pinpoint one or two things that Sierra AI should improve, what would you say are those two things?

Expert 00:31:51

I would say, one, I think we touched on it, the whole transparency aspect of pricing and how they are considering something resolved versus not, what kind of traceability they can actually provide for some of this. The second is probably, again, like I said, the continuous learning loop is a little bit of a black box to us. If we find that they are not applying the right policies or they're not resolving or rather escalating cases to a human that they should not be or things like that, how do we essentially compile that feedback in a meaningful way and give it to them and have it translate in some reasonable timeline into model improvements? All of that is a little bit ad hoc right now, and there's not a guaranteed SLA on the continuous learning loop.

Client 00:32:38

I guess, did you know this since the beginning, or did you discover that, realize, "Oh, this is something that needs to be improved going forward, otherwise it's going to be to get it right?"

Expert 00:32:51

No, I don't think it would be fully absorbed in the beginning. It's something that came out of the deployment itself, I would say.

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Client 00:32:58

Interesting. Perfect. Last question. If you have to evaluate vendors again, knowing what you know right now, what would you change to ensure that you get that you make the best decision in terms of which vendor to choose, how to implement it? I know that this is a very big question, but if you can summarize, what questions would you make to the vendor in the pre-sales process? What metrics would you push the vendor to talk more about, or what would you do differently?

Expert 00:33:29

I think a lot of the process that **we have is pretty solid**. I would also say that, even today, we did ask for some of these gaps right at the beginning, but just that we didn't necessarily have sufficient competitors in the market that were comparable to Sierra AI. We kind of had to pick the best of the lot, if you will. That's kind of how we went with it. I would say just in terms of process, we have it down quite well. What might change is there's a competitive vendor in the market and that might make Sierra AI up their game or maybe the other vendor has certain better aspects to it, that is when we would be able to sort of revisit this.

Client 00:34:11

Perfect. One last question, and I promise this is the last one. I just thought about this one, and I want to get your take on this. What were the other vendors that you evaluated, and how did you get to the first set of vendors to evaluate? Did you get a list from a specific source, and you say, "These are the top AI agent vendors. Let's start to evaluate them," or were those recommended to your team? How did you come up with the set of vendors since the beginning? Which were the other ones that you came very close to choosing them before deciding on Sierra?

Expert 00:34:46

It's usually pretty top down. Usually, there's some connect at the CTO level, and there's some champion at the top that is essentially pushing it down. That is how these vendors sort of become candidates for us. In terms of competitive vendors, we did evaluate Hippocratic, but then I wouldn't say it was purely apples-to-apples because Hippocratic was being evaluated for slightly more clinical conversations, like patient scheduling or pharmacy fulfillment, things like that. Sierra was more back office administrative customer calls, things like that. It wasn't exactly apples-to-apples. I would say, there was not probably a very direct competitor to Sierra exactly that we evaluated here.

Client 00:35:32

Perfect. Thank you. Very helpful. I don't have any more questions. This has been super helpful. Thank you so much for your time, and for the very insightful takes on all of these questions.

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